

POWER^{OF}32

32 Counties : 4 States : 1 Vision



Engaging thousands of citizens, pulling together leaders in business, government and philanthropy, we bridged the borders of 32 counties and 4 states to create one shared vision.

Here is the Power of 32 regional agenda, and the 14 initiatives designed to achieve our shared vision for a thriving region by 2025.







The Power of Bridging Borders

We invite you to read this report about the action agenda of the Power of 32, one of the largest visioning projects ever undertaken. Power of 32 is a four-state, 32-county initiative that bridges borders so that a region united by common needs and opportunities, and rich natural and human resources, can unlock its full potential. By speaking together as one voice and working together on one agenda, we greatly increase our financial, political, and intellectual power.

Every part of the Power of 32 initiative was designed to build relationships and recognition of shared challenges and opportunities, and to create a culture of collaboration around common concerns and shared goals. Today, we have a clearly defined vision for our future. We also have a series of goals, projects, and strategies that are being implemented now to help make that vision a reality.

People have come to understand that in a global economy, the region is the competitive unit. Our success will depend upon our learning from one another, creating a broader sense of home, recognizing that our common best future depends on addressing our common challenges and opportunities together, and building strong partnerships for action throughout the region.

Georgia Berner
Co-Chair, Power of 32
President, Berner International

William Getty
Co-Chair, Power of 32
President, The Claude Worthington Benedum Foundation

Selena Schmidt
Executive Director, Power of 32

Defining the Power of 32 Region

Even before the outbreak of the Revolutionary War, the territory that now comprises the Power of 32 counties was designated a region because of the shared waterways and topography. Over time, the region has enjoyed a storied history and heritage, enviable natural resources, shared infrastructure, and interdependent economic relationships. We are connected in more ways than many of us realize. Yet, lines drawn on a map many, many years ago can, and often do, divide us.

Our region of 17,380 square miles extends from the eastern reaches of the Appalachian Highlands west into the Ohio River Valley. If we were a country, we would be a little larger than Switzerland, but with less than half the people. Most of our population of 4.1 million live in and near urban centers, but most of our territory is considered rural.

Today, the region includes western Maryland, eastern Ohio, southwestern Pennsylvania, and both the northern panhandle and north-central regions of West Virginia. Many of our residents commute to work daily across county and state lines. Pittsburgh International Airport is the major airport for all of us, and we are the home of Steeler Nation.

Ours is a remarkable shared tale of the industrial age, famously identifying our region with coke, coal, and steel. Like generations before us, we take pride in our work ethic and self-reliant character, wrought from our history. Though we have diversified our economy, and have demonstrated a resilience and re-birth that are the envy of many places with an industrial heritage, the wrenching decline of heavy industry and the out-migration that resulted are much more than a distant memory for those who stayed and those who left. Hometown loyalty runs deep, as evidenced by the remarkable number of black and gold jerseys seen in the stands when the Steelers go on the road.

Yet parochial and political differences sometimes have us working against each other rather than together. We need to cooperate more effectively, and compete as a region rather than within the region, wherever it is in our collective interest to do so.



The Power of 32 Regional Agenda: Moving from Visions to Actions

In 156 community conversations in every one of the 32 counties, the Power of 32 collected more than 15,000 comments from diverse people who offered their perspectives on our strengths and challenges, their hopes for our brightest future, and how best to ensure it. The message was clear: if the region is to thrive, the citizens, our leaders, and business, education, and government must work together on common issues and not be stymied by political and parochial boundaries.

Six Issue Teams – Economy, Education, Environment, Government, People & Community, and Transportation & Infrastructure – worked over many months to understand the public’s input and develop aspirational yet achievable goals, policy options, and projects. In order to be included in the regional agenda, a project or policy initiative had to meet three criteria:

- Address a challenge or opportunity that is common across the 32-county, 4-state region.
- Provide a strategy for implementation that is likely to create more progress than a state-by-state approach; that is, be a project where regional collaboration will make a meaningful difference.
- Have a champion — an entity or group committed to achieving each goal through implementation of the regional strategy.

Although each of the 14 initiatives in the regional agenda will be the responsibility of the entity or group that has committed to its execution, overall success will be overseen by the following implementation committee:

Chair: Jim Clements, *West Virginia University*
 Greg Babe, *Bayer Corporation*
 Steve Craig, *Lawrence County Commissioner*
 Pat Getty, *Benedum Foundation*
 Court Gould, *Sustainable Pittsburgh*
 Jim Hunt, *Clarksburg City Council*
 Ed Looman, *Progress Alliance (Steubenville)*

Colleen Peterson, *The Greater Cumberland Committee*
 Scott Rotruck, *Chesapeake Energy*
 Audrey Russo, *Pittsburgh Technology Council*
 Rick Stafford, *Carnegie Mellon University*
 Richard Taylor, *Imbue Technology Solutions*
 Bill Wilmoth, *Steptoe and Johnson (Wheeling)*
 Dennis Yablonsky, *Allegheny Conference on Community Development*

The Implementation Committee will oversee the Power of 32 Fund at The Pittsburgh Foundation, and will regularly report to the people of the region as to progress.

The following pages set forth the public’s vision for economy, education, environment, government, people & communities, and transportation & infrastructure, and the goals and strategies developed by the issue teams for turning vision into action. To learn more about Power of 32, the Community Conversation report, regional agenda, and the regional leaders who served on the six issue teams that developed the goal and strategies, please visit www.powerof32.org.

Power of 32 Regional Visioning Path

Spring 2010	Fall 2010	Winter 2010	Spring/Summer 2011	Fall 2011
• Developed materials: Participant Guide, Outreach Guide, and Facilitator Guide • Conducted training camp to prepare 100 facilitators and 18 outreach coordinators	• Conducted 156 conversations with 3,300 participants and over 15,000 comments	• Analyzed Community Conversation data • Published Report at Powerof32.org	• Researched possible solutions • Built organizational support for 14 goals • Regional Agenda	• Announcement of 14 goals • WQED educational series on Power of 32 • WQED Town Hall Meeting



Jim Clements
West Virginia University



Vince Sands
BNY Mellon

Economy

The Region's Vision for Economy: We have created a sustainable economy, reversed the trend of losing farm land, adopted cost-effective business development practices and become a model of regional cooperation. Our highly diverse economy continues to grow because of the innovations and vision of both our entrepreneurs and our leading businesses and industries, our strong research institutions and our high rates of educational attainment. We have the lowest unemployment rate of any region in the country. Recognizing that shale gas and the broader energy industry will be significant drivers of the regional economy in the next decade and beyond, we have taken steps to assure that this opportunity produces the broadest possible legacy of prosperity.

Create A Regional Venture Fund

Create a regional “Early Stage Fund of Funds” to support start-ups, stimulate entrepreneurial environment, and create high quality jobs across diverse industries.

Intended Outcome:

More new businesses and high-quality jobs.

Strategies to Achieve Goal:

- Create a regional committee to recruit the best possible fund manager or managers.
- Include both a fund intended to achieve market returns and a fund targeting high quality companies in traditional industries that typically do not attract venture investment.
- Draft prospectus.
- Raise funds – target \$100 million.

Organization Leading Goal Achievement:
Regional Governance Committee

Create Better Sites for Business Growth in the Region

Launch a fund to assist development of high-quality sites, emphasizing redevelopment of brownfields, to support business relocations and expansions to the region.

Intended Outcome:

Enhanced global competitiveness by attracting growing companies that provide high-quality jobs.

Strategies to Achieve Goal:

- Due diligence team to evaluate potential of sites region-wide and create a marketing database.
- All regional economic development entities agree to market the identified best regional sites.
- Raise funds to invest in site preparation and development, focused on helping regional sites to attract external expansion and relocation opportunities to the region.
- Fund redevelopment of brownfields in preference to greenfield expansion.

Organization Leading Goal Achievement:
Regional Governance Committee

Education

The Region's Vision for Education: All students in the region have access to high-quality instruction and the most advanced curricula, regardless of district, county, or state jurisdiction. Life-long partnerships have been forged among the PreK-12 education system, higher education, and the business sector, which assure all students are prepared for post-secondary education and that life-long learning is available for the high-demand jobs found in regional growth industries or the entrepreneurial sector.

Education Co-Chairs



Gregg Behr
The Grable Foundation



Kathy D'Antoni
West Virginia Dept. of Education



Nick Deluliis
CONSOL



James Denova
Claude Worthington Benedum Foundation

Create a Regional STEAM Network

Improved academic achievement and mastery of 21st century skills (such as the abilities to deconstruct problems, think flexibly, and work with others to design solutions) through the cultivation of student creativity and inspired learning.

Intended Outcome:

Creation of a regional network of teachers, university researchers, community-based organizations, artists, and commercial entertainment/educational technology experts, the objective of which is to advance best practices in STEAM (Science, Technology, Engineering, Arts, and Mathematics) education in both formal and informal educational settings.

Strategies to Achieve Goal:

- Expand the Kids+Creativity Network membership, professional development opportunities, and partnerships to include institutions in all Power of 32 counties in West Virginia, Ohio, Maryland, and Pennsylvania.
- Provide an easily-accessible platform for promoting the most advanced practices in STEAM education.
- Engage the Kids+Creativity Network to host regular conferences on STEAM education.
- Assist school districts to adopt STEAM strategies and align them to state and national standards.

Organizations Leading Goal Achievement:

The Sprout Fund and the Center for Creativity, Arts & Technology

Match Education Programs to Jobs

Create a standardized and seamless career education system that coordinates curricula between high school and higher education, based on employer hiring needs and job qualifications in regional growth industries.

Intended Outcome:

Increased gainful employment across the region.

Strategies to Achieve Goal:

- Leverage ShaleNet's central database of current and projected employment opportunities, standardized curricula aligned to industry requirements, and a job matching service.
- Begin with the Energy Alliance, which will adapt the ShaleNet model to other energy-related industries. Ultimately, the ShaleNet model could eliminate the geo-political impediments to training and hiring by any regional employer, regardless of industry sector.
- Once a model is developed in the energy sector, it is anticipated that industries having regional workforce demand, like healthcare, can refine and adopt the model.

Organizations Leading Goal Achievement:

Energy Alliance of Greater Pittsburgh

Environmental Co-Chairs



Greg Babe
Bayer Corporation



Anne Barth
TechConnect WV



Richard Taylor
ImbuTec

Environment

The Region's Vision for Environment: Together, we have achieved broad economic growth while preserving our values, integrity, and natural resources. We have built a strong tourist industry. We have developed clean, green technology, community-led environmental protection, robust, environmentally friendly businesses, and many recreational outlets.

Promote Sustainable Use and Conservation of the Region's Water

Create an Ohio River Headwaters Committee to promote policies and resources to protect our region's water, including with respect to diversions and withdrawals from the watershed.

Intended Outcome:

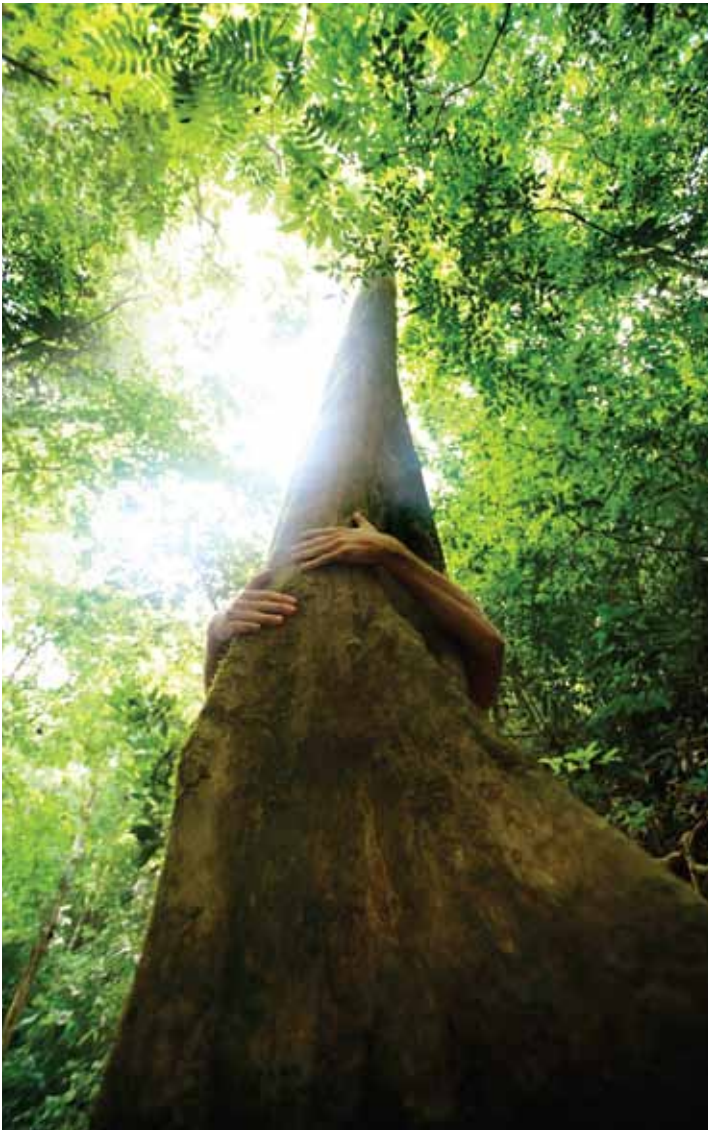
Sustainable use and conservation of the region's greatest asset – water.

Strategies to Achieve Goal:

- Create an Ohio River Headwaters Resource Committee to work with ORSANCO to advance integrated water resources and water quality planning and management in the Ohio River headwaters. The Committee will advocate unique interests of the headwaters region regarding water issues, including policies needed to regulate diversions and withdrawals from the basin of the Ohio River and its tributaries.
- Develop funding assistance to increase regional capacity to engage in water resources management and policy development in order to expand integrated interstate water management.

Organizations Leading Goal Achievement:

Regional Headwaters Resource Committee





Implement a Regional Air Quality Improvement Strategy

Develop a regional air quality improvement strategy and promote the coordination of efforts across the Power of 32 region.

Intended Outcome:

Improved regional air quality.

Strategies to Achieve Goal:

- Endorse the air quality initiative being lead by The Heinz Endowments' Breathe Project and its expansion to embrace the Power of 32 region.
- Conduct a review of the agencies that have jurisdiction for air quality in the Power of 32 region: what they do, degree of cooperation among them, and gaps that point to need for coordination.
- Work to connect regional air quality programs, share best practices and coordinate efforts.

Organizations Leading Goal Achievement:

The Heinz Endowments

Create a Shale Initiative

Develop a comprehensive cross-sector initiative to promote environmentally responsible development of shale gas.

Intended Outcome:

Safe and sustainable development of shale gas.

Strategies to Achieve Goal:

- Engage the National Academies of Science and Engineering to promote science-based development of policy.
- Build a regional cross-sector task force to recommend sound policies and to support and assure that industry meets safety and environmental best practices including:
 - transparency in operations
 - state-of-the-art environmental protection across all operations
 - encouragement of public dialogue
 - maintenance of safe workplaces and being responsible members of the communities in which they work
 - provision of sustainable and broad-based economic and energy-security benefits for all.

Organizations Leading Goal Achievement:

Regional Coalition Convened by the Power of 32
Regional Implementation Committee



Steve Craig
Lawrence County Commission



James C. Hunt
Former Mayor and
Member of Council,
Clarksburg, WV.



Laura Ellsworth
Jones Day

Government

The Region's Vision for Government: Local governments and elected officials cooperate with each other across boundaries and consistently assess how we can improve our region. There is shared economic growth with more harmony among governments, businesses, and residents. More people vote and are excited to support our visionary elected officials and forward-thinking private organizations.

Establish a Power of 32 Caucus

Develop strategic state and federal collaborations including the formation of a caucus of the region's representatives.

Intended Outcome:

State and federal government support of the Power of 32 agenda and future initiatives of common benefit to the region.

Strategies to Achieve Goal:

- Form a federal Power of 32 caucus to encourage regional advocacy and support of the P32 agenda.
- Form a similar caucus with the four governors and state officials.

Organizations Leading Goal Achievement:

Regional Process Facilitated by the Greater Pittsburgh Chamber of Commerce

Develop a Government Best Practices Collaborative

Create a "Best Practices Bank" to share ideas and proven concepts to help governments be as cost-effective as possible.

Intended Outcome:

Foster innovation for more efficient, "smarter" government.

Strategies to Achieve Goal:

- Create a "Best Practices Bank" and a periodic event to convene regional government and policy leaders modeled after the Institute of Politics and in coordination with organizations like the Metropolitan Planning Organizations and Association of Counties and Municipal Leagues.
- Support sharing of best practices.
- Develop a platform for multi-sector, cross-geography leaders to meet, learn, interact, and problem-solve around common issues and concerns.

Organizations Leading Goal Achievement:

Center for Metropolitan Studies at the University of Pittsburgh's Graduate School of Public and International Affairs

People & Community

The Region's Vision for People & Community: We have communities of generous, loyal, friendly, proud, diverse, and successful citizens and boast a worldwide reputation as a great place for all to raise a family, live, work, and play. Our region offers a wide range of job opportunities for a diversified work force, and we value our multi-cultural history. Our region favors partnerships and collaborations, and embraces change. We have strong values, a strong work ethic and strong neighborhoods.

People & Community Co-Chairs



Melanie Harrington
Vibrant Pittsburgh



John Turack
Penn State Cooperative
Extension, SmartGrowth
Partnerships



Susie Nelson
Community Foundation for
the Ohio Valley

Connect the Regional Trail System

Create a comprehensive regional trail network.

Intended Outcome:

Increase recreational opportunities, economic development related to trails, and a greater sense of regional connectedness.

Strategies to Achieve Goal:

- Develop a complete regional map of current trails, planned trails and potential corridors.
- Convene partners.
- Prepare a comprehensive development plan & funding strategy.
- Expand community development projects in trail communities.

Organizations Leading Goal Achievement:
The Progress Fund





Colleen Peterson
The Greater Cumberland
Committee



Rick Stafford
Carnegie Mellon University,
Heinz College, Traffic 21



Al Biehler
Former secretary of PennDOT

Transportation & Infrastructure

The Region's Vision for Transportation & Infrastructure: We are a world leader in innovation in technology and policy for smarter, cleaner, more efficient, and more secure and sustainable transportation. We enjoy a clean, easy-to-navigate, efficient, and non-car-dependant transportation system, fully connecting the region while respecting our environment and the character of our people and places. We have high-speed internet service for all.

Maximize Use of Alternative Fuels

Maximize the transition to alternative fuels for all forms of transportation, prioritizing fleet vehicles and river tugs.

Intended Outcome:

Extensive conversion of vehicles to natural gas and electricity.

Strategies to Achieve Goal:

- Encourage collaborative proposals to gain private sector, government, and foundation funding for infrastructure to facilitate conversion to natural gas and electricity.

Organizations Leading Goal Achievement:

Regional Coalition Convened by the Power of 32 Regional Implementation Committee

Increase Commerce Through Improved Freight Transportation

Develop and maintain a sustainable, multi-modal, interconnected freight transportation system that enables the region to compete globally.

Intended Outcome:

Improved movement of freight to, from, and through the Power of 32 region by highway, rail, water, and air. Elimination of pinch points that delay movement; maintained and improved locks and dams; increased freight movement by rail and waterway; freed-up capacity on roadways, and prioritized projects that will have the greatest regional benefit.

Strategies to Achieve Goal:

- Support a long-term plan for maintenance and improvement of the region's locks and dams.
- Convene a meeting of the four state secretaries of transportation.
- Determine status, schedule, and scope of proposed Pa. and pending W.Va. freight movement studies.
- Convene a regional planning committee.
- Inventory the transportation network across the 32 counties, since all conventional mapping ends at jurisdictional borders.
- Facilitate an analysis of the pinch points and/or improvements that would be necessary to increase rail and waterway share of freight traffic through the region, understanding that those threats/opportunities may lie physically outside the actual 32 counties, but affect the network within them. Increasing the amount of freight on rail and waterways is more fuel efficient and environmentally friendly, and frees up capacity and throughput on the roadways.

Organizations Leading Goal Achievement:

Regional Process Facilitated by the Allegheny Conference on Community Development



Create a Real-Time Traveler Information System

Create a regional travel information system to provide real-time information to enable modal and route choices for people and freight.

Intended Outcome:

Travelers — by foot, bike, car, transit, truck, train, air, or other mode — can plan and execute trips based on real-time, region-wide information.

Strategies to Achieve Goal:

- Connect the 511 systems being developed in the states to create a regional online trip planner.
- Promote operational coordination of the myriad transit agencies within the region, with an eye toward information sharing and trip planning, so that potential riders can understand where and how they can get from A to B by accessing more than one system.
- Add other modes to leverage this resource as an organizing tool and principle with significant value to every corner of the region.

Organizations Leading Goal Achievement:
Carnegie Mellon University's Traffic21

Maximize Success at Competing for Funding

Maximize regional success in competing for private sector, government, and foundation funding for transportation and infrastructure.

Intended Outcome:

Improved regional success in obtaining research, development and deployment grants.

Strategies to Achieve Goal:

- Create a centralized process for identifying competitive funding opportunities, convening appropriate grant-seeking partners, and coordinating grant writing activities.
- Ongoing evaluation and continuous improvement of centralized process for pursuit of funding.

Organizations Leading Goal Achievement:
Regional Coalition Convened by the Power of 32
Regional Implementation Committee

Power of 32 Steering Committee

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Somerset County Chamber of Commerce
Somerset County, PA

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Cranberry Township
Butler County, PA

Ms. Heather Arnet

The Women and Girls Foundation of SWPA
Allegheny County, PA

Mr. Louis P. Astorino

Astorino
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PNC Financial Services Group
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Former Mayor of City of Youngstown
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Steptoe & Johnson
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Ms. Abby Wilson

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Mr. Dennis Yablonsky, ex officio

Allegheny Conference
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Allegheny County, PA

*Executive Committee



Thank You

The Steering Committee is indebted to the Power of 32 staff for its dedication, hard work, and creativity:

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Operations & Project Director

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James Fogarty
Outreach & Technology Director

Laura Pollanen
Public Allies Pittsburgh Executive Ally
Alicia Welsh
Intern

Eric Horgos
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We also thank the many volunteers and organizations which made possible the progress to date. Please go to the acknowledgement page at www.powerof32.org to learn more about the people and entities from across the region who deserve the appreciation of all of us.

And finally, thanks to our sponsors. Without their generous support we could not have accomplished the mission of the project.

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McCune Foundation

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The Pittsburgh Foundation

Hillman Foundation
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Community College of Allegheny County
Community Foundation for the Alleghenies
Community Foundation of Fayette County
Community Foundation for the Ohio Valley, Inc.

Eastern Gateway Community College
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iGate Corporation
Jewish Healthcare Foundation
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Pennsylvania Environmental Council
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PNC Bank
Point Park University
Donald and Sylvia Robinson Family Foundation
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Seton Hill University
Sisterson & Co. LLP
Slippery Rock University
St. Vincent College
Sustainable Pittsburgh
University of Pittsburgh
U.S. Steel
Waynesburg University
West Virginia Northern
Community College
West Virginia University
Westinghouse
Women and Girls Foundation

POWER^{OF}32

32 Counties : 4 States : 1 Vision

A very special Thank You to all of you throughout the Power of 32 region, who volunteered your time and wisdom, your dreams and visions. Without your participation and support this visioning initiative could not have been successful. Because of you, today and going forward we can think differently about our region's challenges, our role in the global economy, our opportunities, our quality of life, and proceed in ways that set a new direction for our future.

